

Delaware County Commissioners Meeting January 2nd 2024

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nfbU2jHk2UU
Publication Date	2024-01-03T02:42:05Z
Target Category	delaware_county

Notice: This report is provided by the [Muncie Policy Memo](#) as a public service. This summary is generated automatically using artificial intelligence from public video transcripts, both of which are prone to error. The report is intended to provide an overview of meeting business and an aid to accessing detailed information from the video recording. When accuracy is critical, please refer to the official video recording or approved minutes.

Delaware County Commissioners Meeting Summary

Date: January 2, 2024

Time: 9:01 AM

1. Pre-Hearing & Committee Work Sessions

- **00:05:13 Public Hearing: Vacation of Alley in the Riordan Area**
 - **Summary of Discussion:** Attorney Leslie Matthew, representing property owner Gary Benedict, presented a petition to vacate an unused, grass-covered alley platted behind lots in the unincorporated town of Riordan (specifically affecting properties on Ann Street and William Street). The request proposes splitting the vacated alley between Mr. Benedict and adjacent owner Michelle Downs. Highway Department representatives noted that a field inspection identified a gas line and a phone/utility line running through or near the alley, raising concerns regarding utility access. The board discussed verifying utility easements with the recorder's office and pipeline companies before taking final action. The public hearing was subsequently closed by motion.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order:** Presiding officer called to order the Delaware County Commissioner meeting on Tuesday, January 2, 2024, at 9:01 AM.
 - **Attendance:**
 - Members Present: Shannon Henry, Sherry Reagan, James King (Presiding Officer)
 - Members Absent: None explicitly noted.
-

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance.
 - **Approval of Minutes:**
 - Table business to approve the December 4, 2023 Commissioners meeting minutes (Approved by Voice Vote).
 - Approval of the December 18, 2023 Commissioners meeting minutes (Approved by Voice Vote).
-

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:12:12 Executive & Department Head Appointments (1-Year Terms)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board of Commissioners.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board reviewed and approved standard annual department head and executive appointments, including Brett Cummings (911 Director), Sarah Hodes (Office Manager / Council Finance Committee), John Brooke (County Attorney), John Coutino (EMA Director), Mike Ashley (EMS Director), Tommy Humbert (Highway Supervisor), Angie Moyer (Assistant Engineer/Project Administrator), Pam McCamon (HR Director), Brian Wilson (Veterans Affairs Officer), Eric Stach (Weights and Measures), Steve Foster (Maintenance Superintendent), Brad Bookout (Economic Development Director), and Kyle Johnson (County Information Officer). Additional board and commission appointments (Drainage Board, Redevelopment Commission, etc.) were also approved en masse.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:14:50 Board, Council, and Commission Reappointments & Adjustments**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board of Commissioners.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board processed various external board appointments. The Board of Health appointments were held for further research due to recent state legislative changes. The Metropolitan Planning Commission appointment for Teresa Hensley was held for review regarding her recent election to the Salem Township Advisory Board. Corrections were made to terms for Fair Board members (Fred Cummings, Joey Kalin, Brandy Webb adjusted to 3-year terms expiring in 2024 to

restore proper rotation). Jodi Cole was added to the Mental Health Administration board.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved with noted holds and corrections by Voice Vote.
- **00:18:39 Presentation: Real Black Excellence**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Stephen Hargrave, Founder.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Stephen Hargrave presented an overview of the local nonprofit Real Black Excellence, highlighting community work including inner-city educational classes, youth programs at South View Elementary, addressing the Industry neighborhood food desert, purchasing Craner field for a community hub, and workforce networking. Hargrave requested community partnership and financial support in the amount of **\$15,000** for an upcoming Black History Month event featuring Grammy award-winning artist Kirk Whalum on February 16, 2024, at the Cornerstone Center for the Arts.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal board vote taken at this time.
- **00:26:06 INDOT Project Coordination Contract**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Angie Moyer, Assistant Engineer / Project Administrator.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Agreement necessary to receive 80% federal reimbursement toward preliminary engineering fees, with a maximum federal fund award amount of \$387,900. The project involves Bridge 75 between Country Village and Shaffer Road (slated for construction around 2029).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:27:22 Corporate Agreement for Title IV-D Court**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily Anderson, Court Administrator.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Annual renewal agreement allowing the Title IV-D court to receive 66.6% reimbursement for qualifying IV-D work. Reviewed and cleared by County Attorney John Brooke.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:28:00 Ordinance Introduction: First Reading (Vacation of Alley in Riordan Edition)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board of Commissioners.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Introduction of Ordinance 2024-001 to vacate a portion of a 12-foot-wide alleyway dedicated by the Riordan plat adjoining Lots 1 and 2 in Block 3 and lot 35 (following the earlier public hearing discussion).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Ordinance 2024-001 introduced and passed on first reading by Voice Vote.
- **00:28:42 Payment of Claims**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Payment of claims presented, noting a total of \$38,298,432.22 (which includes \$35,719,904.16 for a tax settlement) and a

separate claims docket totaling \$21,370.00 (amount partially unquantified/spoken as \$21,370).

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:29:38 Linda Hansen (President, League of Women Voters of Muncie-Delaware County):** Addressed the board to request a formal agenda spot to present data comparing the newly approved county solar ordinance against state standards and recommendations for "Solar Energy Ready Communities," emphasizing ongoing concerns regarding the 500-foot setback requirement.
- **00:30:56 Cheryl Swingley (Educator / Resident):** Addressed the board regarding economic and energy data in Indiana. Noted that Indiana ranks high in coal and natural gas consumption and argued that the county must embrace alternative energy sources like solar and wind to support future business development and state funding. Echoed the request to amend the county's solar ordinance setback requirements.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** No major administrative meeting dates or special announcements were stated prior to adjournment, aside from ongoing scheduling of agency meetings.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was recessed / adjourned by motion.

Muncie Policy Memo Civic Monitoring Automated Pipeline. Report generated on 2026-10-03 15:03:55 using model gemini-3.5-flash-lite.